

Kennedy Johnston

kennedyjohnston@tamu.edu

Texas A&M University | Department of Economics | College Station, TX 77843

Education

Texas A&M University

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Economics (in progress)

Dissertation Committee: Danila Serra (Chair), Catherine Eckel, Jonathan Meer, Laura Dague

College Station, TX

Expected May 2027

University of Nebraska-Lincoln

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

Major: Economics (Honors); Minor: Mathematics

Lincoln, NE

May 2022

Research Fields

Crime; Gender; Behavioral and Experimental

Working Papers

The Under-Reporting of Sexual Assault: An Experiment on Victims, Perpetrators, and Social Judgment 2026

[Link to Paper.](#)

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0015001]

Shaping Major Choice: The Role of High School Counselors 2026

(with Jonathan Meer and Danila Serra)

[Link to Paper.](#)

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0004320]

Works in Progress

A Crime with Little Punishment? The Likelihood of Arrest Following A Sexual Assault Report 2026

Returns to College Grades 2026

(with Jonathan Meer)

The Impacts of Campus Violence: Evidence from College School Shootings 2026

(with Nathan Wise)

Sexual Assault Reporting Platforms and Social Norms: Insights from Callisto Users and an Online Experiment 2025

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0016107]

Grants

Arnold Ventures (planning grant) – \$97,387

(with Danila Serra)

Fall 2024

Scholarships and Fellowships

Gail Frey Monson Memorial Scholarship (Texas A&M University)	2026
MH Webber Scholarship (Texas A&M University)	2025
John Van Huyck Fellowship (Texas A&M University)	2024
Aviles-Johnson Graduate Fellowship (Texas A&M University)	2022

Presentations

Freiburg Ph.D. Workshop on the Economics of Criminal Behavior (Planned), Germany	2026
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (Planned), Houston, TX	2026
The Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar Series (Planned)	2026
Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxEcW), Austin, TX	2026
North-American Economic Science Association (ESA) Conference, Tucson, AZ	2025
Annual Texas Experimental Association Symposium (TEXAS), Waco, TX	2025

Research Experience

Research Assistant

Drs. Jonathan Meer and Danila Serra, Texas A&M University	<i>Spring 2024 – present</i>
Dr. Danila Serra, Texas A&M University	<i>Summer 2023</i>
Dr. Daniel Tannenbaum, University of Nebraska-Lincoln	<i>Summer 2022</i>
Drs. Ann Mari May and Daniel Tannenbaum, University of Nebraska-Lincoln	<i>Summer 2019</i>

Teaching Experience

ECON440: Experimental Economics

<i>Instructor of Record at Texas A&M University</i>	<i>Summer 2025</i>
---	--------------------

ECON441: Policy Economics

<i>Teaching Assistant for Dr. Danila Serra at Texas A&M University</i>	<i>Spring 2024</i>
--	--------------------

ECMT461: Economic Data Analysis

<i>Teaching Assistant for Dr. Craig Schulman at Texas A&M University</i>	<i>Fall 2023, Fall 2025</i>
--	-----------------------------

ECON421: Economics of Crime

<i>Teaching Assistant for Dr. Chelsea Strickland at Texas A&M University</i>	<i>Fall 2022, Spring 2023</i>
--	-------------------------------

Referee Experience

Journal of Policy Analysis and Management

Professional Service

Economic Graduate Student Association

<i>Second Year Representative</i>	<i>College Station, TX August 2023 – May 2024</i>
-----------------------------------	---

Department of Economics, Texas A&M University

<i>First-Year Ph.D. Student Mentor</i>	<i>College Station, TX August 2023 – May 2024</i>
--	---

References

Danila Serra (Chair)

Professor

Department of Economics

Texas A&M University

dserra@tamu.edu

Catherine Eckel

Sara and Jon Lindsey Professor

University Distinguished Professor

Department of Economics

Texas A&M University

ceckel@tamu.edu

Jonathan Meer

Department Head

*Mary Julia and George R. Jordan Professor
of Public Policy*

Department of Economics

Texas A&M University

jmeer@tamu.edu

Laura Dague

James M. Griffin Professor of Health Policy

Department of Public Service and
Administration

Texas A&M University

dague@tamu.edu